Data

Team Synaptech · "Do Collaborator Moves Predict Cross-Language Career Entry?" · Data Lead's section. Every number below was recomputed from the project files (code at commit `eab6f5e`). Open items are marked **[TO CONFIRM: ...]**.

1. Sources and licensing

We combine four public sources. **IMDb** provides the credits: the non-commercial datasets `title.basics`, `title.principals` and `title.akas`, downloaded on 22 October 2026 (file timestamps) **[TO CONFIRM: IMDb snapshot date]**, used under IMDb's non-commercial licence for coursework only. We do not redistribute them: the repository ignores its data directory, and the samples we share contain only identifiers, years, billing order and labels. **[TO CONFIRM: exact IMDb attribution wording required for the submission.] TMDB** supplies each title's original language through the IMDb-ID `/find` endpoint and, for one rule, its `spoken_languages` field. *This product uses the TMDB API but is not endorsed or certified by TMDB.* **Wikidata** (original language, property P364, matched through the IMDb-ID property P345) is our second labelling tier and feeds two rules. **English Wikipedia** (the film-infobox language of the article that links to the IMDb title) is used only for targeted validation and rule (a2) **[TO CONFIRM: attribution wording for Wikidata (CCo) and Wikipedia (CC BY-SA)]**. We queried the three APIs at a rate-limited pace with caching and did not scrape IMDb pages.

2. Scope and filtering

We study feature films and TV movies (`movie`, `tvMovie`) released 1980–2024, using actor and actress credits billed in the top 10, and five focal languages: Hindi (hi), Tamil (ta), Telugu (te), Malayalam (ml) and Kannada (kn). The team fixed 2024 as the end year. A title is a *candidate* if `title.akas` holds an alternate title in region `IN` or in a focal language. This keeps the language lookups to 157,740 titles instead of all 399,097 in the period. Table 1 shows what survives each filter; titles outside the candidate rule are never sent to TMDB.

Table 1. Funnel from the IMDb files to the credit table (version `final_v2`).

Step	Titles	Credits	Note
IMDb title records; principal-cast rows	12,881,968	102,420,102	all types, all years
Actor or actress credits	—	42,496,106	
Billed in the top 10	—	41,475,450	
Feature films and TV movies	916,725	—	`movie`, `tvMovie`
…with a start year	798,693	—	
…released 1980 or later, with ≥1 top-10 actor credit	429,549	3,158,416	3,207,781 rows before dropping 49,365 repeated title–actor pairs
Released 1980–2024	399,097	2,940,846	30,452 titles after 2024 dropped
Indian candidate titles (`IN`-region or focal-language aka)	**157,740**	**1,243,786**	241,357 titles never sent to TMDB
…labelled with a focal language	18,532	155,677	used for language events
…labelled with another language	93,521	801,810	kept with label; never a source or destination
…ties only (no language)	45,687	286,299	45,418 unknown + 269 rule-flagged titles

3. Language assignment and the fallback strategy

Our unit of language is a title's *original* language, assigned in tiers. **T1** takes `original_language` from the TMDB record found by IMDb ID, preferring a movie match over a TV match. **T2** applies only to titles TMDB did not resolve: it takes Wikidata's original language for the item with the same IMDb ID. Titles resolved by neither tier are **unknown**. We never infer language from the cast. Of the 157,740 candidate titles, T1 resolves 108,447 (68.8%), T2 adds 3,873 (2.5%), and 45,420 (28.8%) remain unknown (all years including 2025 onward: 174,014 candidates; T1 118,852, T2 3,941, unknown 51,221). Table 2 gives the match rates by decade and by language.

Table 2. Share of candidate titles resolved by each tier, by release decade and (for resolved titles) by original language.

Group	Titles	T1 TMDB	T2 Wikidata	Unknown
1980s	12,342	76.3%	7.7%	16.0%
1990s	14,533	77.6%	5.6%	16.8%
2000s	28,312	67.9%	2.9%	29.1%
2010s	61,410	66.3%	1.7%	32.0%
2020–24	41,143	67.5%	0.6%	31.9%
All, 1980–2024	**157,740**	**68.8%**	**2.5%**	**28.8%**
By original language (resolved titles only):				
Hindi (`hi`)	5,697	93.8%	6.2%	—
Tamil (`ta`)	4,109	83.2%	16.8%	—
Malayalam (`ml`)	3,933	83.5%	16.5%	—
Telugu (`te`)	3,045	84.3%	15.7%	—
Kannada (`kn`)	2,016	75.1%	24.9%	—

Why unknown titles stay in the graph. A strict inner join on resolved titles would delete every edge contributed by the 45,420 unresolved titles, and with them the collaborations between actors whose only shared film is unresolved. Feedback on our proposal warned that this would fragment the collaboration network. We therefore use a left join: unresolved titles stay in the credit table with no language, so they supply ties but never a language event and never a source-language credit.

What `title.akas` can and cannot do. It cannot give the original language: among the 429,302 titles with alternate titles, the original-title row carries neither a language nor a region in any case. We use it only to shortlist candidates and to flag possible dubs for review. The unknown share depends on this evidence: it is 32.5% of the 135,685 candidates whose only Indian evidence is an `IN`-region title, against 6.3% of the 22,055 with a focal-language alternate title.

4. Candidate-set recall check

To test whether the candidate rule misses focal-language films, we drew 2,000 random titles from outside it and looked each up on TMDB. 1 of them (0.05%; 95% Wilson interval 0.01–0.28%) had a focal-language original language. As far as TMDB can tell, the rule captures almost all focal-language titles; it cannot detect titles that TMDB itself lacks or mislabels.

5. Dubbed and ambiguous titles

Dubbed releases never count as new-language credits, because a title's language is always its original language: a Hindi dub of a Telugu film is a Telugu title, and its actors gain no Hindi credit. A dubbed IMDb entry that carries the dub's language would break this, so we looked for them: the pre-fill described below found 0 dubbed entries in the control sample, and the cross-check agreed on all 29 of its rows. Genuinely multilingual productions cannot be given one original language. We therefore take a title out of language events (it stays in the graph as a tie) when any of three predefined rules fires, applied to the 18,800 focal-labelled titles:

- **(a2)** TMDB `spoken_languages` *and* the IMDb-matched Wikipedia infobox both list two or more focal languages;
- **(b-focal)** Wikidata lists two or more focal languages as original languages;
- **(c)** TMDB's original language is not among Wikidata's original languages (both available).

Table 4. Titles and credits flagged by each rule, and the change in eligible actor–language pairs and first-entry events (differences from the no-rule baseline in parentheses). Rule (a) is the first, TMDB-only version of (a2); see Section 7.

Rule set	Titles flagged	Credits flagged	Eligible actor–language pairs	Events (all 20 pairs)	Smallest pair (events)
No rule (baseline)	0	0	3,998	1,606	24
(a) TMDB spoken languages only	448	3,975	3,932 (–66)	1,462 (–144)	19
(a2) TMDB and Wikipedia	83	740	3,991 (–7)	1,553 (–53)	22
(b-focal) Wikidata	125	1,117	3,986 (–12)	1,549 (–57)	24
(c) TMDB–Wikidata disagreement	108	900	3,989 (–9)	1,560 (–46)	24
(a) + (b-focal) + (c) — `final`	622	5,484	3,911 (–87)	1,396 (–210)	19
(a2) + (b-focal) + (c) — `final_v2` (primary)	269	2,342	3,970 (–28)	1,488 (–118)	22

The primary set flags 269 titles (1.4% of focal-labelled titles) yet removes 7.3% of events (1,606 to 1,488), because bilingual films are where a first credit in a second language tends to arise; eligible pairs fall from 3,998 to 3,970. We also tested plain Wikidata (two or more original languages of any kind), which flags 235 titles, and replaced it with (b-focal) because it counts non-focal languages as second languages.

6. Validation and its limits

We describe exactly what was done. **(i) AI-assisted pre-fill.** We built a review list of 5,672 titles with warning signs (label absent from the title's alternate-title languages: 3,792; unknown with focal-language alternate titles: 1,385; alternate titles in several languages: 938; Wikidata with several languages: 33; a title can have several reasons), ranked by the ties it carries. A language model pre-filled rows using only TMDB and Wikipedia evidence (articles matched by IMDb link), kept the current label unless the evidence was clear, and flagged ambiguity only for a source conflict or a source listing several languages. For T1 titles TMDB is the source of the label, so its agreement is not independent; confidence is "high" only when an IMDb-matched Wikipedia article also agrees. **(ii) Blinded cross-check.** A second language model, shown only title, year and IMDb link, answered 29 rows: the 2 with a corrected language, all 7 flagged ambiguous, and 20 random high-confidence unflagged rows (from 122). **(iii) Human adjudication.** A team member checked all six disagreements against Wikipedia and TMDB (Table 6).

Table 5. Validation checks and results (confidence is high/medium/low).

Check	Sample	Result
Pilot pre-fill	first 30 rows of one reviewer's file	confidence high/medium/low 15/7/8; no evidence 7; ambiguous 1; label changes 0
Control pre-fill	200 random titles from the review list	evidence for 157, none for 43 (42 of them unlabelled); labels changed **0/157 (95% CI 0.0–2.4%)**; 2 unknown labels filled; 7 flagged ambiguous; 0 dubbed; confidence 122/28/50
Blinded cross-check by a second language model	29 rows: 2 corrected, 7 ambiguous, 20 random high-confidence	language agreement **26/29 = 89.7% (95% CI 73.6–96.4%)**; bilingual vs ambiguous 25/29 (86.2%); dubbed 29/29
Human adjudication	the 6 cross-check disagreements	see Table 6

Table 6. Human adjudication of the six cross-check disagreements (three on language, four on the bilingual flag; Asvins differs on both).

Film (year)	Disagreement	Adjudicated finding	Consequence in the data
Lion (2015)	language: cross-check `en`, label `te`	Telugu original; the cross-check had looked up the 2016 film of the same name	Label correct (`te`); no change
Asvins (2023)	language: cross-check `ta`, label `te`	Tamil original (Wikipedia); **TMDB label wrong**	Label wrong in `baseline`; removed from language events by rule (c) in `final` and `final_v2`
Baladoor (2008)	bilingual: cross-check no, pre-fill yes	Telugu original, single-language; dubbed versions exist	Rule (a) false positive; kept as `te` in `final_v2`
Khiladi (2022)	bilingual: cross-check no, pre-fill yes	Telugu original, single-language; dubbed versions exist	Rule (a) false positive; kept as `te` in `final_v2`
Maanaadu (2021)	bilingual: cross-check no, pre-fill yes	Tamil original, single-language; dubbed versions exist	Rule (a) false positive; kept as `ta` in `final_v2`
Rakta Charitra (2010)	language: cross-check `te`, label `hi`	Hindi and Telugu (bilingual)	Correctly flagged; tie only in `final` and `final_v2`

Adjudication found one probable source error: for Asvins, TMDB says Telugu and Wikipedia says Tamil. Counting it, the number of existing labels wrong in the control sample is **1 of 157 (0.6%; 95% CI 0.1–3.5%)**, which is a lower bound, because only 29 of the 200 control rows were human-checked. The control sample is drawn from the review list, whose titles have warning signs, and from the 4,072 titles below its 1,500 highest-impact entries; it therefore describes that higher-risk subset, not all 157,740 candidates, and is not a population error rate. The cross-check is itself fallible (it looked up the wrong film for one title) and shares TMDB and Wikipedia as sources with the pre-fill.

7. Disclosure: refinement of rule (a)

Rule (a) was first defined using only TMDB `spoken_languages` (two or more focal languages). Human adjudication showed that it over-flagged original, single-language films that merely have dubbed versions (Baladoor, Khiladi and Maanaadu). We refined it to (a2) *after seeing this*, so (a2)'s performance on those rows is in-sample. The change was made before we fitted any model.

8. Unlabelled titles and bias

Unknown titles are 28.8% of candidates overall, but the share rises from 16.4% in 1980–1999 (26,875 titles) to 31.3% in 2000–2024 (130,865 titles), with the step around 2000 (Figure 1). We have not tested why. A plausible explanation, which we have not verified, is that the growing number of small recent releases is sparsely covered by TMDB and Wikidata. This implies that focal-language actors may be missing some credits (recent years most), which makes source-language counts conservative, and that recent years are less labelled than early ones.

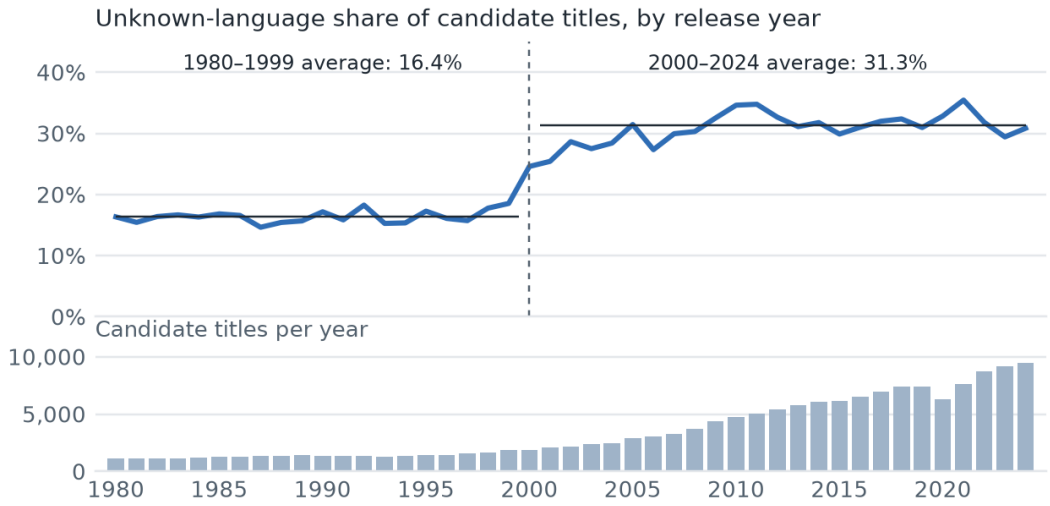


Figure 1. Share of candidate titles with unknown language by release year (top) and number of candidate titles per year (bottom); dashed line at 2000.

In the primary analysis unknown credits are excluded from the 70% denominator (Section 9). Counting them instead would cut eligible actor–language pairs from 3,970 to 3,291: 679 pairs (17.1%) lose eligibility, 676 actors lose every source language, and 222 further pairs qualify later (median delay 3 years). We report both as a sensitivity analysis.

9. The final datasets

Eligibility. An actor–language pair enters the risk set in the first year the actor has at least 5 source-language credits across at least 3 distinct calendar years (not a span, and not necessarily consecutive), with source-language credits at least 70% of all prior labelled credits, and no prior destination-language credit. Credits in other resolved languages count in the denominator; unknown and rule-flagged credits do not. Table 7 lists the named versions: `final_v2` is the primary analysis table, `baseline` (no rules) is for sensitivity, and `final` is the first rule set. The three full versions have identical credits (1,243,786), titles (157,740) and actors (572,755) and differ only in the language label of flagged titles.

Table 7. Data versions (`data/processed/data_versions.csv`); rules a, a2, b-focal and c are defined in Section 5; the last column is the start of each file's SHA-256.

Version	File	Rules	Credits	Focal credits	Ties-only credits	SHA-256 (10)
`pre_review`	`credits_pre_review.parquet`	none	1,243,786	158,012	283,974	`f36308c6cb`
`baseline`	`credits.parquet`	none	1,243,786	158,019	283,957	`81a28e44e4`
`final`	`credits_final.parquet`	a + b-focal + c	1,243,786	152,535	289,441	`e6bf29249f`
`final_v2`	`credits_final_v2.parquet`	a2 + b-focal + c	1,243,786	155,677	286,299	`5d213b30fd`
`sample_final_v2`	`credits_final_v2_sample.parquet`	a2 + b-focal + c	5,844	4,997	509	`03c2bd0307`
`sample_final`	`credits_final_sample.parquet`	a + b-focal + c	5,462	4,019	1,110	`2d60528212`
`sample_baseline`	`credits_sample.parquet`	none	5,518	4,469	624	`6e8ca73580`

Under `final_v2` there are 3,970 eligible actor–language pairs (3,966 actors) and 1,488 first-entry events across the 20 ordered pairs, between 22 and 165 per pair (Table 8). Every pair has at least 5,284 at-risk actor-years and passes the screen's descriptive thresholds (10 events, 100 at-risk actor-years). We have not yet chosen pairs for modelling.

Table 8. Pair screen for `final_v2`: first-entry events, eligible actors and at-risk actor-years per source→destination pair.

Pair	Events	Eligible actors	At-risk actor-years	Pair	Events	Eligible actors	At-risk actor-years
ml→ta	165	735	10,688	te→kn	65	499	6,884
hi→ta	124	1,315	24,605	kn→ta	64	448	7,752
ta→ml	122	643	8,574	ml→hi	59	840	14,348
hi→te	114	1,305	24,659	kn→te	53	457	8,561
ta→te	110	624	8,780	te→hi	50	490	6,964
hi→kn	90	1,345	25,054	ml→kn	39	834	14,230
hi→ml	89	1,348	25,308	ta→hi	39	709	11,165
te→ta	83	440	5,284	te→ml	29	510	7,440
ml→te	78	814	13,648	kn→hi	25	466	8,799
ta→kn	68	687	10,187	kn→ml	22	469	8,938

10. Network connectivity

Table 9 compares connectivity of the focal-language actors with unknown and rule-flagged (ties-only) titles kept in the graph and dropped. Keeping them leaves slightly more actors in the largest component and fewer fragments. Over all 572,755 actors in the table, the largest component holds 87.0% (15,863 components).

Table 9. Connected components among actors with a focal-language credit (actors linked by a shared title).

Version	Focal-language actors	Components, ties kept	Largest component	Components, ties dropped	Largest component
`final_v2` (primary)	32,739	220	96.9%	280	95.8%
`baseline` (no rules)	33,143	222	97.0%	279	95.9%

11. Limitations

- **Unknown titles** are 28.8% of candidates and unevenly spread over time (Section 8); dropping them from eligibility counts may lose real focal-language credits.
- **TMDB errors** exist: we found one (Asvins). Rule (c) removes it from language events in `final` and `final_v2`, but it is still labelled Telugu in `baseline`.
- **Titles without a Wikipedia article** cannot be flagged by (a2): 61 of the 448 titles flagged by rule (a) had no IMDb-linked article (the other 387 had one, and 83 of those are flagged by (a2)).
- **Validation is partial:** 29 of 200 control rows were human-checked; the pre-fill and cross-check share their sources; (a2) was refined in-sample.
- **Merged or missing IDs:** 325 title IDs in `title.principals` (1,446 credit rows) do not appear in `title.basics` and cannot be remapped, since IMDb ships no redirect table.
- **Parsing:** with pandas' default quote handling our reader parsed 102,420,102 of the 102,420,111 `title.principals` data lines (9 merged) and 59,809,790 of the 59,861,136 `title.akas` lines (51,346 merged, 0.09%); `title.basics` was complete. We have not re-run the filters with quoting disabled, so the effect on the counts above is likely small but unmeasured **[TO CONFIRM: re-run]**.
- **Coverage:** IMDb does not include some regional films, and titles outside the candidate rule (never sent to TMDB) are absent from the source-share denominator.
- **Inference:** our results will be predictive association, not causal.

12. Reproducibility

Environment: Python 3.13.0, pandas 3.0.6. Table 10 lists the commands; Table 7 gives the output hashes. Input SHA-256 (first 16 characters): `title.basics.tsv.gz` `5f75a4fb37da0f30`; `title.principals.tsv.gz` `94b081c911ca7b57`; `title.akas.tsv` `fc0e7024fe17df79`.

Table 10. Commands used.

Step	Command
Filter titles/credits; akas candidates and evidence	`filtering.py` functions via a driver script [TO CONFIRM: wrap in a CLI command]
Language labels (T1, T2)	`cinema-mobility resolve-labels --rate 20`
Rule evidence (TMDB, Wikidata, Wikipedia)	`cinema-mobility rules-fetch --wikipedia`
Baseline and primary credits	`cinema-mobility apply-review --reviewed data/review/corrections_control.csv --credits data/processed/credits_final_v2.parquet --baseline data/processed/credits_pre_review.parquet --ambiguity-rules spoken_wiki,wikidata_focal,disagree` (omit the last flag and change `--credits` for `baseline`)
Rule sensitivity; pair screen	`cinema-mobility rules-report --stage full`; `cinema-mobility select-pairs`
Quality report; version table	`cinema-mobility quality-report --end-year 2024`; `cinema-mobility data-versions`

[TO CONFIRM: TA's answer on AI-assisted labelling and rule-based exclusion.]